INGLÉS · NIVEL B1 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Past Perfect en Inglés B1

Aprende el past perfect para indicar cuál de dos eventos pasados ocurrió primero, y úsalo con "when", "after", "by the time" y "already".

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Usar el past perfect para establecer que una acción ocurrió antes de otra acción pasada.

MODELO

When she arrived, I had already eaten. / He hadn't seen the film before we talked about it.

Al terminar podrás

1. Forma el past perfect con had + participio pasado para todos los sujetos
2. Indica cuál de dos eventos pasados ocurrió primero
3. Usa correctly: already, just, never, yet, by the time con past perfect
4. Combina past perfect y past simple en narrativas para secuenciar eventos

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve la práctica y corrige al final. Usa las tres pistas de audio de la lección web para imitar ritmo y entonación.

01 · COMPRENDER

La idea esencial

El past perfect (had + participio) expresa una acción que ocurrió antes de otro momento o acción en el pasado. Es esencial para narrar eventos en el orden correcto y para estructuras como reported speech, conditionals tipo 3 y el uso de "already", "just", "never" y "by the time".

¿Qué es el past perfect y cuándo se usa?

El past perfect expresa el "pasado del pasado" — una acción que ya estaba completada antes de otro punto en el tiempo o antes de otra acción pasada. Se forma con had (igual para todos los sujetos) más el participio pasado del verbo.

Piénsalo como una "máquina del tiempo": cuando ya estás narrando en el pasado y necesitas retroceder aún más, usas past perfect. "When the film started, we had already bought the popcorn." El popcorn lo compraste antes de que empezara la película.

Participios irregulares más importantes

Para el past perfect necesitas dominar los participios irregulares más frecuentes. Los regulares son fáciles: add + -ed (work worked). Los irregulares requieren memorización.

Los más usados: go gone, see seen, eat eaten, write written, take taken, give given, make made, have had, come come, become become, buy bought, think thought.

Infinitivo	Past Simple	Past Participle
go	went	gone
see	saw	seen
eat	ate	eaten
write	wrote	written
take	took	taken

Conectores clave con past perfect

"By the time" es el conector más característico del past perfect: "By the time I arrived, everyone had left." Significa "para cuando llegué, todos ya se habían ido."

"After" también introduce el past perfect: "After she had checked everything twice, she submitted the report." Y "before": "I had never tried sushi before I went to Japan."

Already, just, never y yet con past perfect

Estos adverbios van entre had y el participio: "I had already eaten." / "She had just left." / "They had never been abroad." / "Had you finished yet?"

"Already" confirma que algo pasó antes de lo esperado. "Just" indica que acababa de ocurrir. "Never" expresa experiencias no tenidas hasta ese momento pasado. "Yet" en negativas y preguntas indica si algo había ocurrido o no.

Past perfect vs past simple: ¿cómo elegir?

Si solo hablas de un evento en el pasado, usa past simple: "I ate at 7." Si mencionas dos eventos pasados y necesitas aclarar cuál ocurrió primero, el anterior lleva past perfect y el posterior lleva past simple.

A veces "after" o "before" ya aclaran el orden, y el past perfect no es obligatorio: "After I ate, I watched TV." Pero si el orden no es obvio por el contexto, el past perfect es necesario para evitar confusión.

¿Cómo se forma el past perfect en inglés?

Con "had" + participio pasado, igual para todas las personas: "I had finished", "she had gone". Contracción: 'd ("I'd finished"). Negativo: hadn't + participio; pregunta: "Had you finished?".

¿Cuándo se usa el past perfect?

Para una acción anterior a otra acción pasada: "When I arrived, they had already left" (se fueron ANTES de que yo llegara). Equivale al pluscuamperfecto español ("habían salido"). Suele aparecer con "before", "after", "already", "just".

¿Cuál es la diferencia entre past perfect y past simple?

El past simple narra hechos en orden ("I arrived and they left"); el past perfect marca lo que ya había pasado ANTES ("When I arrived, they had left" = ya se habían ido). El past perfect ordena dos pasados: el "pasado del pasado".

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

Subject + had (not) + past participle

Decide en este orden

1. Had es el mismo para todos los sujetos: I/you/he/she/it/we/they had + participio.
2. Usa past perfect para la acción que ocurrió PRIMERO — past simple para la que ocurrió DESPUÉS.
3. Con "when": "When I arrived, the party had already started." (la fiesta empezó antes de llegar).
4. Con "by the time": "By the time we left, it had stopped raining." (paró antes de salir).
5. Con "after": "After she had studied for weeks, she took the exam." (estudió, luego el examen).
6. Adverbios comunes: already (ya), just (acabar de), never (nunca), yet (todavía — en negativas/preguntas).

Estructura	Ejemplo	Significado
had + participio	I had finished my homework.	Acción completada antes de otra
hadn't + participio	She hadn't eaten anything.	Negativa: acción no realizada antes
Had + sujeto + participio?	Had they met before?	Pregunta sobre el pasado anterior

Errores frecuentes

× "When I arrived, they already left" "they had already left" — usa past perfect para la acción anterior.

× "She had went to the store" "She had gone to the store" — recuerda usar el participio pasado, no el past simple.

× "I had never been there before, so I was nervous" — esta frase es correcta, "never" va entre had y el participio.

02 · MAPA VISUAL

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

By the time we arrived, the show had already started.	Para cuando llegamos, el espectáculo ya había comenzado.
She had studied for months before she took the exam.	Había estudiado durante meses antes de hacer el examen.
I hadn't eaten anything, so I was very hungry.	No había comido nada, así que tenía mucha hambre.
Had you ever visited Colombia before last year?	¿Habías visitado Colombia antes del año pasado?
After they had signed the contract, they celebrated.	Después de haber firmado el contrato, celebraron.
When I woke up, the rain had stopped.	Cuando me desperté, la lluvia había parado.
He had never seen snow before he moved to Canada.	Nunca había visto nieve antes de mudarse a Canadá.
She had just left when you called.	Acababa de salir cuando llamaste.

03 · PRÁCTICA

De reconocer a producir

21 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

Reconoce el past perfect

1. When we got to the party, most people ___ already ___. Opciones: had / left · have / left · did / leave · were / leaving

2. She passed the test because she ___ for weeks. Opciones: had practised · has practised · practised · was practising

3. I ___ never ___ Thai food before that night. Opciones: had / eaten · have / eaten · did / eat · was / eating

4. By the time we reached the airport, the plane ___. Opciones: had taken off · has taken off · took off · was taking off

5. ___ you read the book before he lent it to you? Opciones: Had · Have · Did · Were

6. When I opened the fridge, someone ___ all the cake. Opciones: had eaten · has eaten · ate · was eating

7. She ___ just ___ the report when her boss asked for it. Opciones: had / finished · has / finished · did / finish · was / finishing

8. I didn't enjoy the film because I ___ the book and knew the ending. Opciones: had read · have read · read · was reading

Causa y efecto en el pasado

9. She _____ (not / hear) the news, so she _____ (be) very surprised. Opciones: hadn't heard · didn't hear · hasn't heard · wasn't hearing / was · had been · is · were

10. By the time the deadline _____ (arrive), the team _____ (complete) the project. Opciones: arrived · had arrived · was arriving · arrives / had completed · completed · has completed · were completing

11. When we _____ (arrive) at the restaurant, it was full because we _____ (not / book) a table. Opciones: arrived · had arrived · were arriving · arrive / hadn't booked · didn't book · haven't booked · weren't booking

12. After she _____ (study) abroad for a year, her English _____ (improve) dramatically. Opciones: had studied · studied · has studied · was studying / improved · had improved · was improving · improves

La historia de Ana

13. Ana was nervous on the day of her job interview. By that morning, she _____ (prepare) her answers carefully and _____ (choose) her best outfit the night before. When she arrived at the office, she realized she _____ (forget) to bring her portfolio. Fortunately, the receptionist _____ (already / send) the documents by email. The interview _____ (go) well because Ana _____ (research) the company thoroughly. By the time she _____ (leave), she felt confident she would get the job.

Escribe sin opciones

14. Last weekend was interesting. On Saturday I _____ (visit) a friend who I _____ (not see) for five years. She _____ (move) to a new city and _____ (start) a new job. By the time I _____ (leave) her house, it was almost midnight.

Producción guiada

15. Describe algo que habías hecho antes de empezar este curso/trabajo (usa: I had already...).

_____

16. Describe una situación en la que llegaste tarde y algo ya había pasado (usa: When I arrived, ... had already...).

_____

17. Describe algo que nunca habías hecho antes de un momento específico del pasado (usa: I had never... before...).

_____

18. Explica por qué alguien se sentía cansado/feliz/nervioso (usa past perfect para dar la razón).

_____

Misión: Antes de hoy

19. Escribe algo que habías logrado antes de cumplir 18 (o antes de un año importante de tu vida).

_____

20. Describe algo que nunca habías experimentado antes de un momento específico de tu vida.

_____

21. Explica por qué estabas feliz, nervioso o sorprendido en un momento del pasado (usa past perfect para la razón).

_____

04 · SOLUCIONES

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. had / left — Had + left (participio de leave). "Already" va entre had y el participio.
2. had practised — Had + practised. El entrenamiento ocurrió antes de pasar el examen.
3. had / eaten — Had + eaten (participio de eat). "Never" va entre had y el participio.
4. had taken off — Had + taken off. "By the time" introduce el past perfect para la acción que ya había ocurrido.
5. Had — Pregunta en past perfect: Had + sujeto + participio? "Had you read the book?"
6. had eaten — Had + eaten. La acción de comer ocurrió antes de abrir el refrigerador.
7. had / finished — Had + just + finished. "Just" expresa que acababa de terminar justo antes.
8. had read — Had + read (participio de read, se pronuncia /r d/). Leer el libro ocurrió antes de ver la película.
9. hadn't heard / was — Hadn't heard: no haber escuchado antes es la razón de la sorpresa past perfect negativo. Was: la sorpresa es la reacción/consecuencia past simple.
10. arrived / had completed — Arrived: la fecha límite llegar es la referencia temporal posterior past simple. Had completed: el proyecto estaba terminado antes de la fecha límite past perfect.
11. arrived / hadn't booked — Arrived: la llegada es el punto de referencia past simple. Hadn't booked: no reservar mesa es la causa past perfect negativo.
12. had studied / improved — Had studied: estudiar en el extranjero ocurrió primero past perfect con "after". Improved: la mejora es la consecuencia posterior past simple.
13. had prepared / had chosen / had forgotten / had already sent / went / had researched / left — Had prepared: la preparación ocurrió antes de la mañana del día past perfect. Had chosen: elegir el outfit ocurrió la noche anterior past perfect. Had forgotten: olvidar el portfolio ocurrió antes de darse cuenta past perfect. Had already sent: enviar por email ocurrió antes del momento presente en la historia past perfect. Went: describir cómo fue la entrevista es un hecho pasado simple past simple. Had researched: investigar la empresa ocurrió antes de la entrevista past perfect. Left: en "by the time she left" es la referencia temporal posterior past simple.
14. visited / hadn't seen / had moved / had started / left — Visited: acción principal del pasado past simple. Hadn't seen: la experiencia de no ver a alguien ocurrió antes de la visita past perfect negativo. Had moved: mudarse ocurrió antes de la visita past perfect. Had started: empezar el trabajo ocurrió antes de la visita past perfect. Left: en "by the time I left" el dejar es la referencia posterior past simple.
15. I had already studied some English before I started this course. — Ejemplo: I had already learned basic grammar before I joined this class.
16. When I arrived at the cinema, the film had already started. — Ejemplo: When I arrived at the meeting, everyone had already left.
17. I had never tried Korean food before I visited Seoul. — Ejemplo: I had never spoken in public before that day. / She had never flown before her trip to Europe.
18. She was exhausted because she had worked for twelve hours without a break. — Ejemplo: He was happy because he had just received good news. / They were tired because they had been traveling all day.
19. By the time I was 18, I had already learned to drive and finished school. — Usa: By the time I was [edad], I had already [logro]. Ej: By the time I was 20, I had already moved to another city.
20. I had never lived alone before I started university. — Usa: I had never [experiencia] before [momento]. Ej: I had never felt so confident before that day.
21. I was so nervous at the interview because I hadn't prepared enough. — Usa: I was [emoción] because I had [razón]. Ej: She was excited because she had received a job offer.

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.